ANSWER KEY

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MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (Honours)/ MGU-BBA (Honours)/ MGU-BCA (Honours)

REGULAR EXAMINATION October 2026 Fifth SEMESTER

Discipline Specific Core Course (DSC) - MG5DSCPOL301 - THEORIES OFINTERNATIONAL RELATIONS

Discipline Specific Elective (DSE)

MG5DSEPJM300 - THEORIES OFINTERNATIONAL RELATIONS

(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

PART A

1. Globalization

2. Marxism

3. Theory of Knowledge/ the theory of how and what we can know/ how can we study international relations

4. Gaining more than others/ am I gaining more or less than my rival?

5. Rational decision-making/ Rational choice

6. Postcolonial Feminism

7. Frantz Fanon

8. Interdependence

9. Andre Gunder Frank

10. Political Economy

PART B

11. Second Great Debate in International Relations-centred on the methodological dispute between Traditionalism and Behaviouralism- traditionalists emphasised historical analysis, philosophy and political judgement- scholars like Hans Morgenthau and others favoured case studies and historical insight- treated international relations as a subjective social science rooted in human judgment, norms and context- behaviouralists advocated scientific methods, empirical observation, quantification and systematic theory- shifts analytical vocabulary from abstract "decisions" or "intentions" to measurable actions, stimuli, and response patterns-building to study international politics- borrowed methods and concepts from psychology, sociology, and cybernetics-example-Morton Kaplan's systems theory.

12. Positivism assumes an objective reality- international politics can be studied through observation, causal explanation and scientific methods- post-positivism questions the neutrality of knowledge- emphasises interpretation, discourse, historical context and power-

ontologically, positivists generally accept an independently existing reality- post-positivists examine how social realities are constructed and understood-

13. Liberalism explains international cooperation through economic interdependence, international institutions, democracy and shared interests- Institutions reduce uncertainty- facilitate information-sharing- monitor agreements- democratic governments face domestic accountability- trade increases the costs of conflict- these mechanisms encourage states to pursue mutual gains and resolve disputes through negotiation.

14. Functional spillover occurs when cooperation in one policy area creates pressure for integration in related areas- European integration illustrates this process- cooperation in coal and steel encouraged collaboration in trade, markets, and other economic policies- Functional interdependence generates new demands- encourage institutions and political actors to expand regional integration.

15. Game theory explains strategic decisions- modelling states as actors whose outcomes depend on one another's choices-Prisoner's Dilemma- shows why two rational individuals might not cooperate, even when it is in their best interest to do so- two competing states may increase military spending despite mutual losses- each fears vulnerability if the other arms- repeated interaction, communication and credible agreements can encourage cooperation.

16. Realism explains strategic alliances as instruments for protecting national interests and enhancing security- states assess threats- capabilities- geography- the distribution of power before partnering-through balancing, weaker states may unite against a stronger rival- alliances remain conditional- because changing threats and interests can undermine commitments.

17. Postmodern IR theory- argues that power and knowledge are mutually constitutive- dominant institutions and discourses shape what counts as legitimate knowledge- knowledge categorises populations and legitimises political authority- drawing on Michel Foucault, postmodernists examine how security narratives, geopolitical representations, and expert claims reproduce hierarchies and influence international practices-R B J Walker, Richard Ashley, James Der Derian, David Campbell- critiqued state sovereignty, the domestic/international dichotomy and the concept of anarchy-challenged traditional theories like realism and liberalism by rejecting objective truth, universal metanarratives, and state-centric assumptions-.

18. Constructivism distinguishes Hobbesian and Lockean anarchy through socially constructed state identities and norms- Hobbesian anarchy treats rivals as enemies- making violence and survival central- Lockean anarchy treats states as competitors- recognise one another's sovereignty- consequently, states may compete without seeking each other's destruction or denying territorial independence.

19. Robert Gilpin's political economy framework- explains how state power shapes international markets- through trade policies- monetary arrangements- investment rules- economic institutions- powerful states establish rules favouring their interests- protect

strategic industries- influence access to markets- changes in relative power can produce demands to revise existing economic arrangements and institutions.

20.Immanuel Wallerstein's world-systems theory- semi-periphery occupies an intermediate position between core and periphery- combines industrial development with continuing economic dependence- absorbs pressures from both groups- provides opportunities for upward mobility- intermediate position moderates polarisation- reduces systemic tension- contributes to the relative stability of the capitalist world-economy.

PART C

21. First Great Debate in International Relations- centred on Idealism and Realism- the theoretical clash between idealism (liberalism) and realism that unfolded during the 1930s and 1940s- Idealism/utopianism-inspired by the aftermath of World War I and Woodrow Wilson's Fourteen Points- Norman Angell , Leonard Woolf- believed human beings and states are capable of moral progress and cooperative behaviour- Idealists emphasised international law- collective security- diplomacy and institutions to prevent war- Realists criticised these approaches - championed by scholars like E.H. Carr in his 1939 book *The Twenty Years' Crisi*- .argued that power, national interest and human nature fundamentally shape international politics- morality or goodwill does not dictate state actions-debate highlighted competing understandings of peace, conflict and state behaviour.

22. Part of English School of IR- notably developed and advanced by Hedley Bull-- viewed diplomacy as a fundamental institution that helps maintain order in an anarchical society of states-diplomacy acts as a cultural anchor for international society- Martin Wight- diplomacy as the "master-institution" of international relations- facilitate communication, negotiation and peaceful coexistence among culturally diverse states- diplomatic practices establish shared protocols- mutual recognition- conventions of respect- accommodating differences in language, religion and political traditions- diplomacy sustains international norms- reduces misunderstandings- promotes cooperation without eliminating cultural diversity.

23. Critical Theory challenges the assumption that international order is natural or inevitable- influenced by the Frankfurt School- Robert Cox argued that theory is always for someone and for some purpose- traditional "problem-solving" theories serve the status quo and help elites maintain power- critical theory seeks emancipation- global politics is shaped by deep economic and social structures, history, and human agency rather than fixed, ahistorical laws like "anarchy"-Critical Theory examines domination- inequality- ideological structures while imagining emancipatory alternatives- transforming global institutions remains difficult because entrenched power relations constrain meaningful change.

24. David Harvey's concept of time-space compression- follows Marx's concept of annihilation of space by time- describe how capitalism perpetually tries to overcome geographic distance-technological innovation- faster communication- accelerated transportation- reduced the perceived significance of geographical distance and time- capitalism drives this process through rapid circulation of commodities, information and finance- global connectivity increases- its benefits remain unequal- intensifying economic competition- cultural transformation and geographical disparities.